

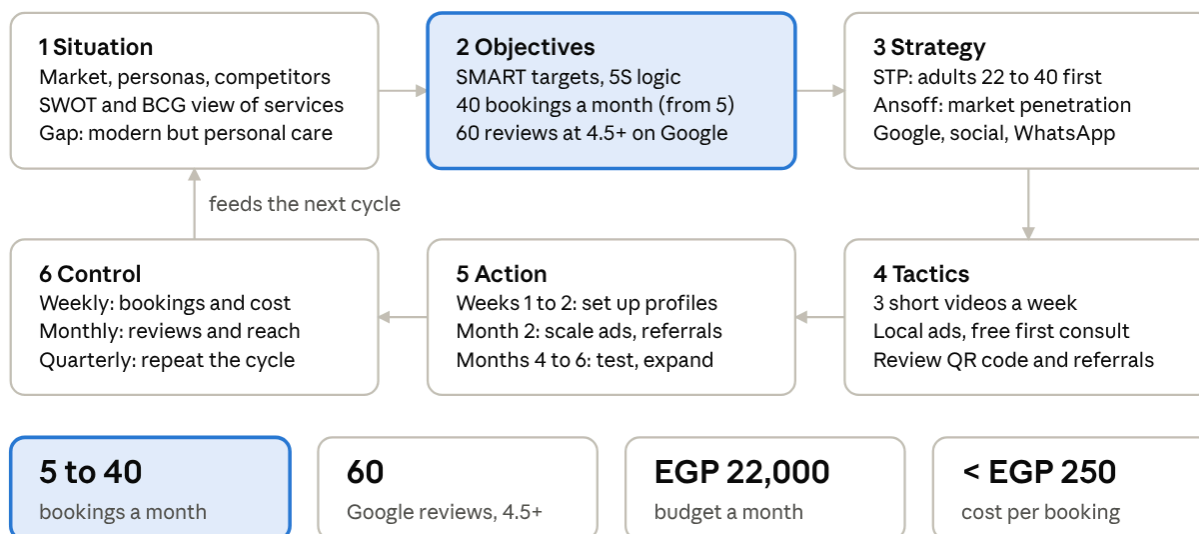
SOSTAC Digital Marketing Plan: BrightSmile Dental Clinic

A practical case study by Ismail Salah | Digital Marketing For Healthcare Professionals (MedSpark)

Note: BrightSmile is a fictional clinic created for learning and portfolio purposes. All figures marked as *assumption* are illustrative and should be replaced with real data in a live project.

At a Glance

Six SOSTAC steps aim to lift BrightSmile from 5 to 40 bookings a month



BrightSmile is a fictional clinic; all baselines and budgets are assumptions.

SOSTAC cycle · 6 steps and key targets

Read the six steps from Situation to Control; Control feeds the next cycle of analysis.

Executive Summary

BrightSmile is a newly opened, mid-priced dental clinic in Cairo, Egypt, offering general dentistry, orthodontics (braces and clear aligners) and cosmetic dentistry. It is a strong clinic with modern equipment, but it has low awareness and almost no digital presence. This plan uses the **SOSTAC** framework (Situation, Objectives, Strategy, Tactics, Action, Control) to build awareness, generate qualified appointment requests and turn first-time patients into loyal, referring patients over the next 6 months.

S: Situation Analysis

1. Clinic Overview

- **Services:** check-ups and cleaning, fillings, root canal, whitening, braces and clear aligners, veneers.
- **Location:** a residential and commercial neighborhood in Cairo with strong foot traffic.
- **Team:** 3 dentists, 2 assistants, 1 receptionist (assumption).
- **Current digital presence:** a Facebook page with few followers, an unclaimed Google Business Profile, no website, no tracking of how patients find the clinic.

2. Market Analysis

- Demand for cosmetic and orthodontic care is growing, driven by social media and the influence of before/after culture.
- Patients usually search on Google Maps and ask friends or family before choosing a dentist, so reviews and word of mouth matter most.
- Facebook, Instagram, TikTok and WhatsApp are the main channels used by the target audience in Egypt.
- Price sensitivity is high, so clear pricing information and installment options are a competitive advantage.

3. Customer Personas

Persona	Profile	Needs	Where to reach
Sara, 27	Working professional, wants a better smile	Whitening, aligners, convenient hours	Instagram, TikTok, Google Search
Mona, 38	Mother of two, manages family health	Trusted dentist for the whole family, gentle with kids	Facebook, WhatsApp groups, Google Maps
Omar, 22	University student, limited budget	Affordable braces, payment plans	TikTok, Instagram, Facebook

4. Competitor Analysis

	Large dental chain	Neighborhood clinic	BrightSmile
Price	High	Low	Medium

	Large dental chain	Neighborhood clinic	BrightSmile
Equipment	Very modern	Basic	Modern
Social media	Very active, paid ads	Almost none	Weak (to be built)
Google reviews	Many	Few	None
Personal care	Low (high volume)	Medium	High (small team)

Gap in the market: patients want modern care with a personal touch at a fair price. Chains feel impersonal, and small clinics lack trust signals online.

5. SWOT

Strengths	Weaknesses
Modern equipment, friendly small team, fair pricing	No brand awareness, no website, no reviews

Opportunities	Threats
Growing demand for cosmetic dentistry, weak digital presence of local competitors	Big chains with large ad budgets, price wars, negative reviews

6. Portfolio View (BCG Matrix)

- **Star:** clear aligners and cosmetic dentistry (high growth, growing share). Invest in marketing.
- **Cash cow:** check-ups, cleaning and fillings (steady demand, low promotion cost). Maintain and use as an entry point.
- **Question mark:** kids' dentistry (growth potential, currently low share). Test with small campaigns.
- **Dog:** low-demand specialty services. Offer only on request and do not promote.

O: Objectives

Objectives follow the SMART approach and the **5S** logic (Sell, Serve, Speak, Save, Sizzle). Baselines are *assumptions*.

Objective	Target (6 months)	Baseline
Sell: monthly new-patient appointments from digital channels	40 per month	5
Speak: Google reviews with an average rating of 4.5+	60 reviews	0
Speak: Instagram and Facebook combined followers	5,000	600
Serve: WhatsApp response time during opening hours	Under 10 minutes	Not tracked
Save: cost per booked appointment	Under EGP 250	Unknown
Sizzle: patients who refer a friend	20% of new patients	Not tracked

S: Strategy

STP

- **Segmentation:** by need (cosmetic, orthodontic, family care) and by age group.
- **Targeting:** primary segment is adults 22 to 40 interested in cosmetic care and aligners; secondary segment is mothers aged 30 to 45 deciding on family dental care.
- **Positioning:** *"Modern dental care with a personal touch, at a price that makes sense."*

Growth Direction (Ansoff Matrix)

- **Market penetration (main focus):** win more patients in the existing neighborhood with the current services.
- **Service development:** launch aligners consultations and family packages.
- **Market development (later):** reach nearby neighborhoods through location-targeted ads.
- **Diversification:** not recommended at this stage.

Channel Strategy

Channel	Role	Priority
Google Business Profile and Maps	Capture people searching now	High

Channel	Role	Priority
Instagram and TikTok	Build awareness and trust through short videos	High
Facebook	Reach families and run local ads	High
WhatsApp Business	Convert interest into bookings	High
Website (simple, mobile-first)	Credibility, pricing and online booking	Medium

T: Tactics

Content Pillars

1. **Educate:** short tips (how to brush correctly, myths about whitening, when to see a dentist).
2. **Build trust:** meet the team, clinic tour, sterilization process.
3. **Show results:** patient stories and transformations, **only with written patient consent.**
4. **Engage:** Q&A, polls and "ask the dentist" sessions.

Tactics by Channel

- **Google Business Profile:** claim and complete the profile, add photos, services and hours, and ask every satisfied patient for a review through a QR code at reception.
- **Instagram and TikTok:** 3 Reels or short videos per week, using the content pillars above.
- **Facebook:** local ad campaign targeting people within a few kilometers of the clinic, promoting a free first consultation and clear pricing.
- **WhatsApp Business:** profile with services catalog, quick replies, appointment reminders and follow-up messages after treatment.
- **Referral program:** a discount on cleaning for both the patient and the friend they refer.
- **Email/WhatsApp retention:** 6-month check-up reminders.

Healthcare Marketing Ethics

- Obtain written consent before sharing any patient photo or story.
- Never share private medical information.
- Avoid exaggerated claims or guaranteed results.
- Follow local health advertising regulations and the clinic's professional code of conduct.

A: Action Plan

Period	Key actions	Owner
Weeks 1 to 2	Set up and optimize Google Business Profile, WhatsApp Business, social accounts and tracking; shoot an initial batch of photos and videos	Marketing lead
Weeks 3 to 4	Launch content calendar, start review collection, soft-launch the Facebook ad	Marketing lead and clinic manager
Month 2	Scale the best-performing ads, launch the referral program	Marketing lead
Month 3	Review results, adjust budget and content, start the website	Marketing lead and owner
Months 4 to 6	Test kids' dentistry and aligner campaigns, expand location targeting	Whole team

Budget (assumption)

Item	Monthly (EGP)
Paid ads (Facebook, Instagram, Google)	12,000
Content production (video and photos)	6,000
Tools (scheduling, WhatsApp Business API, analytics)	2,000
Referral rewards	2,000
Total	22,000

C: Control

KPIs and Tracking

KPI	How to measure	Review
Booked appointments by source	Ask every patient "how did you hear about us?" and use WhatsApp click tracking	Weekly

KPI	How to measure	Review
Cost per booked appointment	Ad spend divided by appointments	Weekly
Google reviews and rating	Google Business Profile	Monthly
Followers, reach and engagement	Platform insights	Monthly
WhatsApp response time	WhatsApp Business statistics	Weekly
Referral rate	Referral code usage	Monthly
No-show rate	Clinic booking system	Monthly

Review Process

- **Weekly:** short check on ads and bookings, with quick fixes.
- **Monthly:** compare results to targets, decide what to scale, change or stop.
- **Quarterly:** revisit the full SOSTAC cycle, as Control feeds back into the next Situation analysis.

Risks and Responses

Risk	Response
Negative review	Reply professionally within 24 hours and invite the patient to resolve it privately
Low ad performance	Test new creatives and audiences, pause what doesn't work
Team can't handle the lead volume	Add a booking assistant before scaling ads further

Key Takeaways

- Digital marketing for healthcare is built on **trust first**: reviews, education and transparency come before promotion.
- SOSTAC keeps the plan connected: the Situation analysis shapes the Objectives, which drive the Strategy, Tactics and Actions, and Control feeds learning back into the cycle.
- Frameworks like the BCG and Ansoff matrices help decide where to focus limited budgets.

Prepared by Ismail Salah as a learning project after completing Digital Marketing For Healthcare Professionals with Dr. Abeer Elleithy.

Acknowledgments and Feedback

Thank you, Dr. Abeer Elleithy, for the clear explanations throughout the course. The lesson that stayed with me most is that an effective campaign starts with understanding the market, and that idea shaped how I structured this plan.

I would value your feedback on three points:

1. Are the objectives (5 to 40 monthly bookings within 6 months) realistic for a new clinic?
2. Is there a channel or tactic I should have prioritized differently?
3. Which part of the plan needs the most improvement?